

SHIWEI LIAO

Doctoral Applicant | Media, AI & Digital Health

North Melbourne, VIC 3051 • +61 406 906 580 • sherwin.shiwei.liao@outlook.com • sherwinliao.github.io

RESEARCH PROFILE

University of Melbourne Master of Global Media Communication graduate (WAM 80.38) studying how AI enables institutions to extend what they are authorised to say and do. My research connects media and communication, platform governance and digital health, with a particular interest in how institutional roles, authority and responsibility are enacted through AI-mediated services and interfaces. Current doctoral development compares non-clinical intermediaries such as Ant/Afu and nib, while an emerging HCI direction examines how shifts in authority and responsibility are made visible, understood and potentially redesigned through interaction.

EDUCATION

Master of Global Media Communication

2023 – 2025

The University of Melbourne, Faculty of Arts — Melbourne, Australia

- Weighted Average Mark (WAM): 80.38; completed July 2025.
- Minor Thesis: “Governing via AI Broadcasting in the Digital Era” (87/100, H1; approximately 12,750 words). Supervised by Dr Wilfred Wang. Using Fairclough’s critical discourse analysis and NVivo-assisted keyword-frequency/co-occurrence analysis, the thesis examined how Chinese AI policy and CCTV’s 2024 AI Gala construct technological legitimacy and state-media authority. This work established my broader research interest in how AI reshapes what institutions are authorised to say and do.
- Selected H1 results: Global Communication: Theory & Research (88); Media and Communications Thesis Part 1 & 2 (87); Media Convergence and Digital Culture (86); Digital Politics (85); Researching Audiences and Reception (85); Global Data Policy & Governance (80); Researching Media & Communications (80).

Bachelor of Broadcast Announcing and Anchoring Art

2017 – 2022

Communication University of Zhejiang — Hangzhou, China

- Cumulative average 87.42/100. Four-year programme in broadcast announcing and anchoring, media production and communication practice, providing an early foundation for analysing institutional voice, mediated authority and public presentation.

CURRENT DOCTORAL RESEARCH DIRECTION

PhD Research Direction in Development

2025 – present

AI, Institutional Authority and Health Intermediation

- Core question: How does AI enable institutions to extend what they are authorised to say and do?
- Current comparative focus: Ant/Afu and nib as two non-clinical intermediary institutions that increasingly use AI to interpret health concerns, recommend action and route users toward care within different service ecosystems.
- Media and communication contribution: examines how AI reconfigures institutional roles, legitimacy, responsibility and platform intermediation. Medical knowledge is treated as a resource through which authority is assembled, rather than as a separate medical-epistemology research problem.
- Cross-disciplinary HCI direction: examines how shifts in institutional authority and responsibility are enacted and perceived through interface cues, recommendations, disclaimers, routing and human-service handoffs. Methods centre on comparative walkthrough and qualitative interface analysis, with focused user research and design evaluation as an emerging extension.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- AI, institutional authority, platform governance and institutional role change
- AI-mediated interfaces, responsibility, routing and authority handoffs
- Human-computer interaction and human-centred AI: user understanding, interaction design and evaluation
- Critical discourse analysis, qualitative interface analysis and walkthrough methods
- Chinese state media, AI discourse and platform political economy

SELECTED COURSEWORK RESEARCH PROJECTS

Extinction Rebellion’s Global Communication Strategy Through the Lens of Scale

Global Communication: Theory & Research (MECM90020) — 88/100, H1

- Examined non-state actor transnational communication through scale theory, tracing how decentralised climate activism operates across local, national and global registers.

Seeing the City Through AI Glasses

Media Convergence and Digital Culture (MECM90007) — 86/100, H1

- Analysed AI smart glasses as wearable urban media infrastructure using CCTV's Winning with AI+ as a case, extending my interest from institutional AI discourse toward interfaces, media infrastructures and body-space-data relations.

Navigating the Privacy Paradox: TikTok's Role in the Digital Public Sphere

Researching Audiences and Reception (MECM40003) — 85/100, H1

- Used semi-structured interviewing and framing theory to examine how TikTok's algorithmic curation shapes privacy perception. Supports current methodological preparation for qualitative interviewing and platform governance analysis.

Cyber-Fascism and the Amplification of Disinformation in the 2024 U.S. Presidential Election

Digital Politics (MECM90016) — 85/100, H1

- Applied a Foucauldian power/discourse lens to digital platforms, disinformation and algorithmic amplification. Demonstrates capacity to connect platform architecture, governance, political discourse and ideological effects.

Digital Silk Road in the Context of China's Digital Economy Work Points 2024

Global Data Policy & Governance (MECM90002) — 80/100, H1

- Analysed China's digital economy policy, Digital Silk Road strategy, data governance and cross-border infrastructure cooperation, supporting my current focus on how institutional authority is organised across platforms and governance systems.

Media Marketing and Crisis Discourse on TikTok

Researching Media & Communications (MECM90038) — 80/100, H1

- Compared BBC and Guardian coverage of TikTok's data-privacy crisis through qualitative content analysis and NVivo-assisted coding. Demonstrates early training in platform crisis discourse, media framing and qualitative coding.

PUBLICATIONS AND WORKS IN PROGRESS

From AI Gala to Spring Festival Gala: The
Infrastructuralisation of AI Discourse in Chinese State
Media

In preparation

- Article manuscript extending the minor thesis by comparing CCTV's 2024 AI Gala with the 2026 Spring Festival Gala. Examines how AI shifts from a visible object of technological legitimation to an embedded production condition, further developing my interest in how AI changes the institutional capacities of state media.

Accidental Soft Power: How Viral Medical Narratives
Reshape China's Medical Soft Power

In preparation

- Develops the concept of accidental soft power through a viral China-treatment narrative, examining how competing platform and institutional frames can produce unintended shifts in perceptions of national medical authority.

RELEVANT PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Online Test Preparation Instructor (IELTS and PTE)

2021 – 2023

Freelance, China

- Delivered one-on-one and small-group English-language test preparation across multiple online platforms. Developed pedagogical skills relevant to potential tutoring duties during doctoral candidature.

Media and Communications Intern

2018 – 2019

Hangzhou TV Group / Anji News Group — Hangzhou and Anji, China

- Conducted on-location public interviews and supported live broadcast logistics within state-affiliated news organisations. Direct experience of Chinese broadcast newsrooms informs later analysis of state media authority, performance and discourse.